



aken up to develop the places in the state visited by Shri Ram an. Development of the Ashram of Sutikshana and Sarbhanga Van and Kamad Giru in Chitrakoot. Setting up of a cultural on of a research fellowship for research on Ramvan Path are e state.

Culture provides grants to private literary as cultural nizing their activities. Financial assistance is given to artists ulture department runs Fine Art Institutes at Dhar, Indore, ur and music colleges at Mansan, Dhar, Ujjain, Gwalior, Narsingharh.

n Art Museum "Saket" has been set up at Orchha under al complex scheme of Government of India. Such complexes ed at Ujjain, Jabalpur and Gwalior. There is a plan to set up the dhisha, Burhanpur, Sagar and Rewa. The building of Tulsi hitrakoot has been completed and a large library has been set

up there. A Marathi Sahitya Prabhagha has been set up under Madhya Pradesh Sanskriti Parishad.

The rare records collected by the Akademis working under Madhya Pradesh Sanskriti Parishad have been documented and uploaded on the department's website. A plan is being chalked out to establish a "Leela Gurukul Sansthan" as a training center for Ram Lila and Ras Lila and "Krishnayan-Ujjain".

The setting up of a "Khayal Kendra" is also on cards. It will be a training center for vocal tradition.

The state government has decided to provide grants to the rural art troupes for functioning musical instruments, which will be a great encouragement to them.

The state government has also made innovative efforts to preserve and protect the monuments in the state. An encyclopedia containing details of all the archaeological monuments is going to be brought out shortly. The State Museum has been shifted to a new majestic building constructed at a cost of Rs. 10 crore at Bhopal. The galleries of the museum showcase stone and bronze sculptures, paintings, coins, documents, arms and weapons, fossils, articles found in various excavations, manuscripts of books, documents of the archives, textiles, stamps, photographs and rare musical instruments. It also has an air-conditioned auditorium, exhibition hall and state-of-the-art facilities including touch screen.

The number of protected monuments has increased from 282 to 342 in the state.

A Rs. one lakh award has been instituted in the name of Padmshri Dr. V.S. Vakankar, who discovered the Bhimbetka rock paintings of primitive man, to recognize outstanding work in the field of archaeology.

One would, thus, see that the present state government in Madhya Pradesh is making committed efforts to preserve and enrich the great cultural and art heritage that adds to the joy de vivre.

